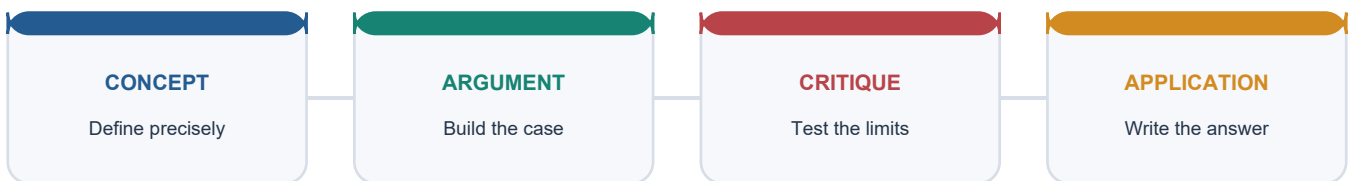


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Phenomenology (Husserl) - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section A | 32 diagnostics with 128 option explanations, 7 solved PYQs, 2 supporting routed parts and 6 original Mains models

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Phenomenology (Husserl) - Solved Practice Workbook

Standalone workbook. It reproduces the complete practice apparatus of the Phenomenology (Husserl) learning package and can be worked without the teaching sessions. Syllabus, verbatim: *Phenomenology (Husserl): Method; Theory of Essences; Avoidance of Psychologism* - UPSC Philosophy Paper I, Section A, item 9. **Evidence discipline:** FACT: doctrine on which the standard sources converge · ANALYSIS: analytical reconstruction for exam use · CAUTION: a live scholarly dispute. Model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys; UPSC publishes no descriptive model answer for Philosophy Paper I. **Terminology and citation rule:** the English concept leads and the source term follows immediately in parentheses - *natural attitude* (*natürliche Einstellung*), *general thesis* (*Generalthesis*), *suspension* (*epoche*), *bracketing* (*Einklammerung*), *residue* (*Residuum*), *essence* (*Wesen, eidos*), *intuition of essences* (*Wesensschau*), *profile* (*Abschattung*), *primal impression* (*Urimpression*), *re-presentation* (*Vergegenwärtigung*), *lived body / physical body* (*Leib / Körper*), *pairing* (*Paarung*), *appresentation* (*Appräsentation*), *life-world* (*Lebenswelt*). *Ideas I* is cited by **Section number**, stable across the Boyce Gibson (1931) and Kersten (1982) translations; the *Logical Investigations* are cited **by volume**, since Volume I is the *Prolegomena* and Volume II holds the six Investigations. Several texts here are posthumous in whole or in part - the time-lectures (ed. Edith Stein, published by Heidegger 1928), the German *Cartesian Meditations* (1950, after the French of 1931), and the *Crisis* (Parts I-II 1936; full text 1954) - and the dates are examinable.

What this workbook contains

Component	Count
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Question-specific option explanations	128
Unique examiner traps	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full, 2018-2025	7
Supporting routed parts that bear on this clause but are owned elsewhere	2
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6

How to use it

1. Attempt the twenty-four core MCQs without notes, then read every option explanation, including those for the options you rejected. The key sequence is **unpatterned** - each answer was fixed independently - so no cycle can be guessed, and option lengths are matched so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape.
2. Attempt the eight remedial drills only after the core set. Each targets a confusion that recurs in scripts every year, from the dating of the *Crisis* and the French-first *Cartesian Meditations* to the misattributed Frege sentence and the ownership fence around Topics 02, 04, 07 and 10.
3. Write each PYQ under time before reading its solution, and check your script against the **demand-decoding table** rather than against the model answer's wording. ANALYSIS: Three of the seven owned parts are **method** parts asked in three different framings - 2021 through the natural attitude, 2023 through bracketing and reduction, 2025 through the "I think" - so hold the method as a set of **distinct operations with stated purposes**, not as a ladder to be recited.
4. Read the two supporting routed parts for their **boundary notes**: 2018 Q4(a) is owned by Topic 10 and 2022 Q4(b) by Topic 02, and each carries an explicit statement of what this clause may and may not contribute. ANALYSIS: **2018**, the only year in which this clause owns nothing, is one of them - and it still opens by asking what the epoche is.
5. Finish with the six original Mains models, two at each mark value, which test the same doctrine at three lengths and in framings the 2018-2025 corpus has not used.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed **independently**, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated, and no cycle such as ABCD can be used to guess. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

Coverage: the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - *Method; Theory of Essences; Avoidance of Psychologism* - together with the sense of "to the things themselves", the general thesis and the exact character of the criticism of the natural attitude, what the epoche brackets and what survives it, suspension against Cartesian doubt, the residue, the four distinct operations and the three purposes they serve, intentionality as directedness, the hallucination case, the noema and the picture error, the principle of principles with its limiting clause, profiles and horizons, graded evidence, hyle and morphe with the anti-sense-datum consequence, retention against recollection, protention, essence against separated Platonic form, free imaginative variation against induction, intuition of essences against categorial intuition, the correlational a priori, the four *Prolegomena* arguments, and the transcendental-turn objection with its reply. The eight remedial drills attack the confusions that cost marks every year: the dating of the *Crisis*, the French-first publication of the *Cartesian Meditations*, the misattributed Frege sentence, the contested causal claim about Frege's review, the editorial history of the time-lectures, the status of the transcendental ego, what the Fifth Meditation does and does not claim, and the ownership fence around Topics 02, 04, 07 and 10 and Paper II.

MCQ 1. What "to the things themselves" asks for

Husserl's watchword *zu den Sachen selbst* stands in the Introduction to Volume II of the *Logical Investigations*. Which reading of it is correct?

- A. It is a demand to ground philosophy in physical objects, whose independent existence is the one datum no philosophical theory may set aside.
- B. It is a demand to replace description with explanation, so that appearances are traced back to the underlying causes that produce them.
- C. It is a demand to return to subject-matters as they give themselves, and away from inherited theories about them.
- D. It is a demand to abandon technical vocabulary, since ordinary language already contains everything philosophy needs to say.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it converts the motto into naive realism, whereas *Sachen* means matters or subject-matters, and the existence-positing of physical objects is exactly what the epoche suspends.
- **B:** Incorrect: the order of inquiry is reversed - Husserl's complaint is that explanation has been allowed to run ahead of the description it presupposes.
- **C:** Correct: the slogan directs attention to what is given, in the manner of its givenness, in place of the constructions philosophy has inherited about it.
- **D:** Incorrect: Husserl coins and refines technical vocabulary continuously; the motto concerns the source of evidence, not the register of language.

Examiner trap 1: Translating *Sachen* as "things" and then treating the motto as a realist manifesto reverses its meaning, because the inherited construction the motto rejects includes the natural-attitude assumption that the first question about anything is whether it exists.

MCQ 2. The general thesis

What does Husserl identify as the **general thesis** (*Generalthesis*) of the natural attitude?

- A. The continuously operative positing that the world exists, has always existed, and would exist independently of my awareness of it.
- B. The explicit judgement, made whenever we begin to reason, that our senses are on the whole reliable guides to the properties of things.
- C. The scientific hypothesis, revisable in principle, that nature forms a single causally closed system open to mathematical description.
- D. The methodological assumption, adopted for convenience, that the objects of everyday life may be treated as though they persisted unobserved.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the thesis is a standing, lived positing rather than an occasional judgement, and it frames every particular belief rather than competing with them.
- **B:** Incorrect: reliability of the senses is a claim *within* the attitude; the thesis is presupposed by any assessment of reliability whatever.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is a substantive scientific commitment, and Husserl's point is that such commitments already operate inside the general thesis.
- **D:** Incorrect: "adopted for convenience" makes the thesis optional and explicit, whereas it is neither - nobody adopts it, and nobody states it until a philosopher suspends it.

Examiner trap 2: Describing the general thesis as a belief we hold suggests it could be corrected by evidence; it cannot, because it is the medium in which evidence is weighed, which is precisely why the remedy has to be a change of attitude rather than an argument.

MCQ 3. The scope of the natural attitude

Consider the following claims about the natural attitude.

1. It is confined to pre-scientific common sense, which the natural sciences have outgrown.
2. It includes the natural sciences, which dispute what the world contains but not that it is there.
3. Husserl argues that it is false, and that phenomenology corrects the error.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 2 only

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: confining the attitude to common sense removes the point that makes the criticism philosophically serious.
- **B:** Incorrect: statement 2 is right, but statement 3 misstates the criticism, which is that the attitude is uncritical rather than mistaken.
- **C:** Incorrect: both members are wrong, and combining two errors cannot produce a correct answer.
- **D:** Correct: only statement 2 survives - physics and biology contest the world's contents while presupposing that it is there as an independent domain, and empirical psychology treats consciousness as one worldly item among others.

Examiner trap 3: Writing that Husserl refutes the natural attitude turns a change of attitude into a counter-argument, and it immediately forfeits the strongest sentence available in a 2021-type answer - that the defect is a blocked question and not a false belief.

MCQ 4. What the bracket falls on

In the epoche, what exactly is placed in brackets?

- A. The stream of consciousness, so that only the objects presented in it remain available for description.
- B. The existence-positing of the general thesis, while the full descriptive content of what appears is retained.
- C. The content of experience, so that only the bare fact that experience occurs is retained for analysis.
- D. The distinction between veridical and non-veridical experience, which the phenomenologist thereafter agrees to set aside entirely.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it inverts the operation - the stream, with all its intentional contents, is precisely the residue that remains.
- **B:** Correct: the bracket falls on a validity-claim and never on a content, which is why the tree may still be described as green, seen from this side, and horizoned.
- **C:** Incorrect: emptying the content would leave nothing to describe and would make phenomenology impossible rather than possible.
- **D:** Incorrect: the distinction is not ignored but re-described through fulfilment and disappointment, which is how the hallucination case is handled.

Examiner trap 4: The loose formula "the epoche brackets the world" is close enough to sound right and wrong enough to lose the mark; what is bracketed is the world's *existence-positing*, and the world as experienced is retained in full.

MCQ 5. Suspension against Cartesian doubt

Which one of the following states the difference between the epoche and Cartesian methodic doubt most accurately?

- A. Doubt denies what can be doubted in order to reach the indubitable; the epoche withholds assent in order to reach what is purely given.
- B. Doubt is applied to the deliverances of the senses alone, whereas the epoche is applied to the senses, the intellect and the testimony of others alike.
- C. Doubt is a psychological exercise performed once, whereas the epoche is a logical operation that need never be performed at all.
- D. Doubt suspends judgement about the external world, whereas the epoche suspends judgement about the existence of the thinking self.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the two differ in operation, in aim and in result - denial against withholding, the indubitable against the purely given, a thinking substance against a field of constitution.
- **B:** Incorrect: scope is not the issue; a doubt of unlimited scope would still be a denial and not a suspension.
- **C:** Incorrect: the epoche is emphatically something that must be *performed*, and it is repeatable rather than notional.
- **D:** Incorrect: it reverses the positions - Husserl brackets the world's positing and retains the stream, whereas Descartes finds the self indubitable.

Examiner trap 5: Equating the epoche with doubt makes Husserl a sceptic about the world, and every later step then reads as an attempt to recover something he never gave up; a script that opens this way rarely recovers the topic.

MCQ 6. The phenomenological residue

What is the **residue** (*Residuum*) left by the epoche?

- A. A minimal core of indubitable propositions about the self, from which the remaining structures of experience are subsequently inferred.
- B. The abstract form of experience in general, stripped of the particular qualities that distinguish one experience from another.
- C. The whole field of pure experience as lived, with its intentional contents, described exactly as it gives itself.
- D. The set of hyletic data, which under the reduction become the immediate objects of phenomenological observation.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it reimports the Cartesian architecture of a small indubitable base plus inference, which is exactly what the change of attitude avoids.
- **B:** Incorrect: the residue is not an abstraction from experience but experience itself, and the qualitative detail is what makes description possible.
- **C:** Correct: the field is wider, not narrower, than before, because nothing about it is now being assumed from outside.
- **D:** Incorrect: hyletic data are lived through rather than observed, and treating them as objects would restore the sense-datum theory Husserl rejects.

Examiner trap 6: Calling the residue "what is left over" invites the picture of a shrunken remainder; the examinable point is the opposite - bracketing the existence-posit releases descriptive features, such as horizon and profile, that the natural attitude never records.

MCQ 7. Two operations that are constantly confused

Which one of the following correctly distinguishes the phenomenological reduction from the eidetic reduction?

- A. The phenomenological reduction is performed by the philosopher, whereas the eidetic reduction can be performed by any competent user of a language.
- B. The phenomenological reduction redirects inquiry to how objects are given; the eidetic reduction moves from the factual instance to its essence.
- C. The phenomenological reduction concerns outer perception, whereas the eidetic reduction concerns inner perception and the objects of reflection.
- D. The phenomenological reduction is a preliminary exercise, whereas the eidetic reduction is the only operation that yields genuine knowledge.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: neither operation is distinguished by who performs it, and both are methodological rather than sociological notions.
- **B:** Correct: their targets differ - a posit and a manner of givenness on one side, an invariant on the other - which is why they are distinct operations rather than two stages of one.
- **C:** Incorrect: the inner/outer division is not the axis; eidetic variation applies to perceived things, melodies and judgements alike.
- **D:** Incorrect: it introduces a ranking Husserl does not make and obscures the point that each answers a different question.

Examiner trap 7: Fusing the two reductions is the specific confusion the 2023 examiner is testing for, and the corrective is a single clause - one brackets *existence*, the other extracts *essence*.

MCQ 8. Why bracket at all

Which one of the following is **not** among the three purposes Husserl's bracketing and reduction serve?

- A. To secure first-person evidence under a changed attitude, apodictically as experienced though not with exhaustive transparency.
- B. To avoid the Cartesian substance-inference by analysing consciousness as intentional life rather than as a separate mental thing.
- C. To open the eidetic and transcendental questions that factual commitment had kept closed.
- D. To establish, prior to any description, that the material world does not exist independently of consciousness.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect as an answer, correct as a purpose: the stream is unavoidable as experienced, while particular self-descriptions remain corrigible.
- **B:** Incorrect as an answer, correct as a purpose: refusing the substance-inference is what separates Husserl's "I think" from Descartes'.
- **C:** Incorrect as an answer, correct as a purpose: only a field cleared of factual commitment can be varied for invariants.
- **D:** Correct as the answer: nothing of the kind is established, since the operation withholds assent on existence rather than deciding it, and Husserl's later transcendental idealism is an argued result, not a consequence of the bracket.

Examiner trap 8: Treating the epoche as a short proof of idealism runs three sessions together, and it makes the later argument about constitution look like a redundant repetition of something already secured.

MCQ 9. What intentionality asserts

Which one of the following best states Husserl's thesis of intentionality?

- A. Consciousness is always accompanied by an act of will, so that even perception involves an element of choice about what is attended to.
- B. Every act of consciousness is consciousness of something, and this directedness is an essential and irreducible feature of it.
- C. Every mental state has a physical correlate, so that consciousness can be studied indirectly through the states of the organism.
- D. Every experience refers to an object outside consciousness, whose existence is thereby guaranteed by the experience itself.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it confuses "intentional" with "deliberate"; the term derives from *intendere*, to aim at, and covers perception, memory and hallucination alike.
- **B:** Correct: directedness is essential rather than incidental, and it is analysed as the correlation of noesis with noema.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is precisely the naturalistic programme the 1911 *Logos* essay opposes, and under the reduction the organism is bracketed as a worldly object.
- **D:** Incorrect: intentionality entails no existence, which is why imagination and hallucination are full intentional acts.

Examiner trap 9: Glossing intentionality as "aboutness that reaches a real object" quietly smuggles reference into a doctrine about directedness, and it makes the 2019 hallucination question unanswerable.

MCQ 10. Hallucination

On Husserl's account, why is a hallucination a genuine intentional act?

- A. Because it has a perceptual-seeming noesis and a fully determinate noema, and lacks only intuitive fulfilment by a worldly object.
- B. Because every state of the organism, whether veridical or not, has causal antecedents that can be described in the same terms.
- C. Because the hallucinated object exists as a mental image, which then serves as the intentional object in the absence of a physical one.
- D. Because the epoche has suspended the existence of all objects, so that no experience can be more or less veridical than another.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the act is lived in the manner of perceiving and its object is determinate in shape, colour and place, while the missing fulfilment shows itself as disappointment in the further course of experience.
- **B:** Incorrect: causal antecedents belong to empirical psychology, and appealing to them abandons the phenomenological question entirely.
- **C:** Incorrect: it reinstates the inner picture that the noesis-noema analysis exists to remove.
- **D:** Incorrect: the epoche suspends the *positing* of existence, and phenomenology retains the veridical/non-veridical difference as a difference in fulfilment.

Examiner trap 10: Answering "yes, because everything is intentional" states the conclusion without the explanation the 2019 part explicitly demands; the marks lie in naming the perceptual-seeming noesis, the full noema and the absent fulfilment.

MCQ 11. The noema

Which one of the following is the **core** claim about the noema that no answer may omit?

- A. That it is a Fregean sense, distinct from the object, which mediates the act's relation to whatever the act is about.
- B. That it varies with the act, so that the same object intended in perception and in memory yields two numerically distinct noemata.
- C. That it is not an inner picture standing between the act and the world, but the object precisely as intended in that act.
- D. That it belongs to the hyletic stratum of the experience, and is therefore disclosed only by reflection under the reduction.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect as the core claim: the ideal-sense reading is one interpretation among several and belongs to the optional block, not to the compulsory doctrine.
- **B:** Incorrect: it is a consequence discussed in the interpretive literature, not the claim that protects the doctrine from collapse.
- **C:** Correct: denying the intermediary is what prevents the veil of ideas from returning, and it is agreed across the competing interpretations.
- **D:** Incorrect: the hyle belongs to the noetic side, whereas the noema is the object-side of the correlation.

Examiner trap 11: Choosing a positive account of the noema and defending it as though it were settled doctrine mistakes an open scholarly dispute for the syllabus content; what is required is the negative claim that the noema is not a mental picture.

MCQ 12. The principle of principles

Ideas / Section 24 states the principle of principles. Which formulation preserves its content?

- A. Originary presentive intuition legitimates cognition: what is given is to be taken as it presents itself, within the limits of that presentation.
- B. Whatever is clearly and distinctly perceived by the understanding is true, since a non-deceiving God guarantees the general reliability of our cognitive faculties.
- C. Every judgement must be traceable to a sense-impression, failing which it is to be dismissed as an empty verbal construction.
- D. Whatever survives free imaginative variation is an essence, and essences constitute the only legitimate objects of philosophical knowledge.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the limiting clause is doctrine, and it is what makes phenomenological evidence graded rather than total.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is Descartes' criterion together with the divine guarantee that Husserl's method makes unnecessary.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is an empiricist criterion of meaning, and it would exclude the categorial and eidetic intuitions Husserl requires.
- **D:** Incorrect: it states the eidetic technique rather than the evidential principle, and it wrongly restricts knowledge to essences.

Examiner trap 12: Quoting the principle without "within the limits in which it is there presented" turns a carefully bounded evidential rule into a claim of infallibility, and it makes the graded account of evidence look inconsistent.

MCQ 13. Profiles and horizons

Which one of the following correctly describes the givenness of a spatial thing?

- A. It is given whole in each act of perception, since otherwise we could not know that it is one thing rather than several.
- B. It is given as a bundle of sense-data, from which the mind infers the existence of a persisting external object.
- C. It is given in a single privileged profile, the others being reconstructed afterwards by imagination or by memory.
- D. It is given in profiles, with unseen sides co-intended in an internal horizon and identity secured by a synthesis.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: perspectival givenness is essential to spatial objects, and the unity is achieved through the series rather than in any member of it.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is the sense-datum model with its inference to the world, which the hyle/morphe analysis expressly blocks.
- **C:** Incorrect: no profile is privileged, and the unseen sides are co-intended in the present act rather than added later.
- **D:** Correct: profiles, internal and external horizon and the synthesis of identification together explain how one object can be given through many appearances.

Examiner trap 13: Treating the horizon as vagueness loses its content; it is determinable indeterminacy - the unseen back is given as there to be seen in a determinate range of ways, which is what allows anticipation to be disappointed.

MCQ 14. Evidence

How should Husserl's notion of evidence (*Evidenz*) be characterised?

- A. As a private feeling of certainty accompanying some judgements, whose presence marks them off from judgements that are merely believed.
- B. As formal derivability from premises already accepted, so that a claim counts as evident when it follows from what is granted.
- C. As the fulfilment of an empty intention in intuition - dynamic and graded, with adequacy an ideal limit for transcendent objects.
- D. As the agreement of a plurality of observers, so that what all competent subjects report is thereby established as evident.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: a feeling of certainty is exactly what Husserl refuses, since feelings guarantee nothing and the account would collapse into psychologism.
- **B:** Incorrect: derivability presupposes evidence for the premises, so it cannot be what evidence consists in.
- **C:** Correct: evidence is an achievement in experience that admits of degrees, and *Ideas I* Section 24's limiting clause is its charter.
- **D:** Incorrect: intersubjective agreement is a constraint on eidetic claims, not a definition of evidence, and it would leave a unanimous error indistinguishable from a truth.

Examiner trap 14: Writing that phenomenology rests on self-evident certainty hands the examiner the Ryle-Ayer objection unopposed; the defensible formulation is that evidence is graded fulfilment, testable by further and counter-variation.

MCQ 15. Hyle

What is the status of the sensuous **hyle** in *Ideas I* Section 85?

- A. It is the object of perception in the strict sense, from which the perception of the physical thing is subsequently built up.
- B. It is non-intentional sensory content, lived through rather than observed, and animated by an intentional apprehension.
- C. It is the noematic core of the act, and therefore the aspect of the experience that carries reference to the world.
- D. It is a physiological process in the sense organs, which phenomenology describes in its own vocabulary.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: making hyletic data the objects of perception is precisely the sense-datum theory the analysis is designed to exclude.
- **B:** Correct: hyle is a dependent moment, found only in reflection under the reduction, and only the animated whole intends an object.
- **C:** Incorrect: hyle belongs to the noetic side, and the noema is the object-as-intended on the other side of the correlation.
- **D:** Incorrect: physiological processes belong to the natural attitude and are bracketed with the rest of the worldly domain.

Examiner trap 15: Calling hyle "an object of perception" collapses Husserl into Locke and Russell in a single phrase, and it destroys the very argument that separates him from them.

MCQ 16. What the hyle/morphe analysis buys

Which consequence follows from the claim that hyletic data are lived through rather than observed?

- A. That perception is infallible, since the material of experience is given without the possibility of misinterpretation.
- B. That the difference between veridical perception and hallucination cannot be drawn within phenomenology at all.
- C. That consciousness must be understood as a container in which sensory items are stored before being interpreted.
- D. That there is no veil of ideas and no inference from inner data to an external world, contrary to Locke and Russell.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: apprehension can misfire, which is exactly why disappointment and correction of sense are part of the account.
- **B:** Incorrect: the difference is drawn through fulfilment and concordance, not abandoned.
- **C:** Incorrect: the container image is Brentano's residue, which the noesis-noema analysis replaces.
- **D:** Correct: since the data are never the objects of perception, no gap opens between an inner item and an outer thing, and no inference is required to cross one.

Examiner trap 16: Reciting the hyle/morphe pair without stating this consequence leaves the distinction looking like technical decoration; naming Locke and Russell converts it into the strongest available defence against the charge of subjectivism.

MCQ 17. Retention and recollection

Which one of the following states the distinction between retention and recollection correctly?

- A. Retention holds the just-past within the present perception; recollection re-presents what is no longer present.
- B. Retention preserves the general sense of what occurred; recollection preserves its particular sensory detail with greater accuracy.
- C. Retention operates in perception alone; recollection operates in imagination, judgement and every other kind of act.
- D. Retention is unconscious and automatic; recollection is conscious and therefore open to error in a way retention is not.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: retention is primary memory and a moment of *this* perception, while recollection is secondary memory, a re-presentation (*Vergegenwärtigung*) of what has passed away.
- **B:** Incorrect: the contrast is not one of accuracy or generality but of whether the phase is still held within the living present.
- **C:** Incorrect: recollection is not confined to imagination, and retention is required wherever any temporal object is experienced, including a spoken sentence.
- **D:** Incorrect: the unconscious/conscious axis is not Husserl's, and it obscures the point that retention is what makes the sequence experienceable at all.

Examiner trap 17: Calling retention "a kind of memory" is the single most costly slip in this material, because if the just-past note were remembered rather than still heard, the melody would already have to be complete before it could be perceived.

MCQ 18. Protention

What shows that protention is genuinely operative in experience?

- A. That we can predict the future course of events with reasonable accuracy whenever the surrounding circumstances are familiar.
- B. That we can deliberately anticipate what will happen next, and can suspend the anticipation when we choose.
- C. That memory of the past improves when the events remembered were expected at the time they occurred.
- D. That an unexpected turn in a melody is experienced as a disappointment, which presupposes a prior anticipation.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: predictive success is an empirical matter and belongs to the natural attitude, not to the structure of the living present.
- **B:** Incorrect: protention is an empty anticipation internal to the present, not a deliberate act that could be switched off.
- **C:** Incorrect: it describes a psychological correlation, and no such correlation could establish a structural feature of temporal givenness.
- **D:** Correct: disappointment is only possible where something was already intended, so the failure of the anticipation is what exhibits its presence.

Examiner trap 18: Treating protention as prediction relocates it from the structure of the present into the psychology of the person, and it makes the argument about the melody unavailable, since a prediction is precisely what the hearer of an unfamiliar tune does not have.

MCQ 19. The status of essences

Which one of the following correctly states Husserl's position on essences?

- A. Essences are Platonic Forms inhabiting a separate realm, of which particular instances are imperfect copies.
- B. Essences are the products of mental acts of abstraction, and their validity is therefore relative to the acts that generate them.
- C. Essences are ideal and objective, disclosed in and through instances, without occupying any separate realm.
- D. Essences are useful fictions, adopted because they simplify description, and dispensable in a completed science.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Husserl explicitly denies the separation (*chōrismos*); there is no two-world theory and no doctrine of copies.
- **B:** Incorrect: if essences were generated by acts, the theory of essences would itself be psychologism, which the *Prolegomena* rules out.
- **C:** Correct: essences are ideal, non-psychological and intersubjectively accessible, and they are given *in* the instance rather than behind it.
- **D:** Incorrect: fictionalism cannot support the claim that eidetic science grounds the regional ontologies.

Examiner trap 19: The standard misdescription "Husserl's essences are Platonic Forms" is cheap to correct and highly visible, because the correction simultaneously shows why the eidetic reduction begins from a factual instance rather than from a definition.

MCQ 20. Free imaginative variation

Why is free imaginative variation not a form of induction?

- A. Because it is performed on remembered rather than perceived cases, and memory yields greater certainty than perception.
- B. Because it seeks the limit at which a phenomenon collapses, so that a single instance suffices to launch it.
- C. Because it is confined to mathematical objects, where the outcome can be checked by formal proof.
- D. Because it proceeds by enumerating every possible case, and thereby attains completeness that induction lacks.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the contrast has nothing to do with memory, and Husserl makes no such claim about its comparative certainty.
- **B:** Correct: induction generalises from observed frequency and yields probability, whereas variation is an a priori procedure conducted in imagination and looks for what cannot be varied away.
- **C:** Incorrect: the technique is applied to perceived things, melodies and judgements as readily as to geometrical figures.
- **D:** Incorrect: exhaustive enumeration is impossible and unnecessary, and claiming it would reinstate the very appeal to cases that the method avoids.

Examiner trap 20: Writing "not induction" without saying why leaves an assertion where an argument was wanted; the argument is that a limit, unlike a frequency, is not made more secure by further instances.

MCQ 21. Two intuitions that must not be collapsed

How should categorial intuition and eidetic intuition be related?

- A. They are two names for one doctrine, which Husserl held unchanged from 1901 to the end of his career.
- B. Categorial intuition is a species of sense-perception, whereas eidetic intuition is a form of discursive inference.
- C. Eidetic intuition belongs to the *Logical Investigations*, and categorial intuition replaces it entirely after the transcendental turn of 1913.
- D. Categorial intuition, introduced in the Sixth *Logical Investigation*, is the closely related ancestor of later eidetic intuition.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it flattens a genuine development, and the resulting account cannot explain why the vocabulary changes after 1913.
- **B:** Incorrect: neither is a species of sense-perception, and eidetic intuition is expressly a seeing rather than an inference.
- **C:** Incorrect: the chronology is reversed - categorial intuition is the earlier notion, from Volume II of the 1900-01 work.
- **D:** Correct: categorial intuition fulfils intentions directed at states of affairs and categorial formations, and later eidetic intuition through variation is closely related without being identical to it.

Examiner trap 21: Citing "the *Logical Investigations*" without the volume is the recurring provenance error in this clause, since Volume I contains the *Prolegomena* arguments and Volume II the six Investigations, of which the Sixth carries categorial intuition.

MCQ 22. The correlational a priori

What does Husserl mean by saying that essences exhibit a continuity between consciousness and being?

- A. That the essential structure of the act and the essential structure of the object-as-experienced are correlated and not separately describable.
- B. That consciousness and being are ultimately the same reality, described in two vocabularies for different purposes.
- C. That every essence has both a mental and a physical instance, so that the two orders run parallel to one another.
- D. That the mind produces the being of its objects, which therefore possess no determinate structure whatever independent of the acts that intend them.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the essence of "perception of a spatial thing" specifies perspectival acts and a profiled, horizoned object at once, and neither specification is available alone.
- **B:** Incorrect: identity is precisely what "continuity" denies; the claim is structural correlation, not the merger of two poles.
- **C:** Incorrect: parallelism posits two orders that happen to correspond, whereas the correlational a priori denies that they are separately statable.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is the production reading Husserl rejects when he insists that constitution is disclosure rather than fabrication.

Examiner trap 22: Answering the 2024 part with a general account of essences ignores the word "continuity", which names a specific thesis; without the two-sided worked case the answer is off-demand however accurate it is.

MCQ 23. The four Prolegomena arguments

Which argument against psychologism turns on the fact that the psychologist's own conclusion undermines its own support?

- A. That psychological laws are inductive and at best merely probable, whereas logical laws are necessarily and unconditionally true.
- B. That the causal conditions under which we must think are not the grounds of a logical law's validity.
- C. That species-relative truth is self-refuting, since the relativist's thesis is itself asserted as absolutely true.
- D. That the ideal content of a judgement is not a feature of the real, datable act of judging it.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the modal argument shows that the derivation fails, not that the psychologist contradicts himself.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is the genetic-fallacy argument, which concerns explanation rather than self-refutation.
- **C:** Correct: if logical laws are empirical generalisations about thinking, the psychologist's own reasoning is only probable, so his conclusion undermines the support he offers for it.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is the root confusion from which the others follow, but it is not itself the reflexive argument.

Examiner trap 23: Listing the four arguments without identifying (ii) as the root confusion and (iii) as the strongest at 15 and 20 marks produces an answer that is complete and unranked, which is exactly what "critically discuss" penalises.

MCQ 24. The transcendental-turn objection

The charge is that locating all meaning-constitution in the transcendental ego reinstates psychologism. Which reply is Husserl's?

- A. That logical laws are constituted differently in different transcendental egos, so that an irreducible plurality of logics must be accepted.
- B. That the transcendental ego is not the empirical psyche, and that constitution is disclosure of sense rather than fabrication of it.
- C. That the objection is unanswerable, and that phenomenology therefore abandons the claim to ground the ideal sciences.
- D. That psychologism was never refuted in the first place, since the *Prolegomena* arguments concerned only arithmetic.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: a plurality of logics is the relativism the third *Prolegomena* argument shows to be self-refuting.
- **B:** Correct: the empirical psyche is a mundane object within the world, whereas the transcendental ego is the condition of world-sense; and subjectivity is the medium of access, not the source of validity.
- **C:** Incorrect: Husserl neither concedes the charge nor abandons the grounding ambition, though he does not settle the question decisively.
- **D:** Incorrect: the *Prolegomena* target logic generally, and Husserl never retracts them.

Examiner trap 24: Answering the 2022 part with the four arguments alone stops one step short of the question, which names transcendental phenomenology and therefore demands the reflexive worry, the three-part reply, and a verdict that concedes the reply is coherent rather than decisive.

MCQ 25. Remedial drill - dating the Crisis

How should the publication status of *The Crisis of European Sciences and Transcendental Phenomenology* be stated?

- A. Written and published in full in 1936, in the journal *Philosophia*, and reissued in German book form after the war.
- B. Composed in the 1920s and withheld by Husserl, then published in a single authorised edition shortly before his death.
- C. Parts I-II published in 1936 in *Philosophia*; Husserl died in 1938; the complete text appeared only in 1954.
- D. Assembled from lecture notes by Heidegger and issued under Husserl's name in the year of his death.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: only Parts I and II appeared in 1936, and the work was left unfinished.
- **B:** Incorrect: there was no authorised complete edition in Husserl's lifetime, and the composition date is wrong.
- **C:** Correct: the full text appeared as *Husserliana* VI, edited by Walter Biemel, and David Carr's English translation followed in 1970.
- **D:** Incorrect: this confuses the *Crisis* with the time-lectures, which Edith Stein edited and Heidegger published in 1928.

Examiner trap 25: "The *Crisis* (1936)" implies a finished book and invites the further error of treating the unfinished later sections as settled doctrine; the safe form names both dates in six words.

MCQ 26. Remedial drill - the Cartesian Meditations

Which statement about the *Cartesian Meditations* is correct?

- A. The German text appeared in 1931 and was translated into French by Levinas and Peiffer in the following year.
- B. The work was delivered as lectures in Freiburg in 1929 and published simultaneously in French and in German.
- C. The work was written in French by Husserl himself and only later rendered into German by his assistants.
- D. The French translation appeared first, in 1931; the German text was published posthumously in 1950.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the order is reversed, and it is the German text that is the later of the two.
- **B:** Incorrect: the lectures were delivered in Paris in February 1929, and there was no simultaneous publication.
- **C:** Incorrect: Husserl wrote in German; Levinas and Peiffer produced the French translation.
- **D:** Correct: *Meditations cartésiennes* (1931) precedes *Cartesianische Meditationen* (1950, *Husserliana* I); Dorion Cairns' English translation appeared in 1960.

Examiner trap 26: Writing "*Cartesian Meditations* (1931, German)" costs a provenance mark and also loses a free point of interpretation, since the French-first publication explains why Levinas is both the work's first translator and its sharpest critic.

MCQ 27. Remedial drill - the misattributed sentence

Which of the following may safely be written in an answer about Frege's 1894 review?

- A. Frege's objection is, in substance, that explaining arithmetic by the arithmetician's mental operations confuses content with act.
- B. Frege wrote that one might as well try to explain astronomy by the psychology of astronomers, and this sentence alone decided the matter.
- C. Frege's review declared that Husserl's book had reduced arithmetic to a branch of experimental psychology in the manner of Wundt.
- D. Frege refused to review the book, and his objection to psychologism is known only from his correspondence with Husserl.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: this is the safe paraphrase of the charge, and it names the act/content confusion that the *Prolegomena* later develop.
- **B:** Incorrect: the astronomy sentence is a circulating textbook paraphrase and must not be presented as Frege's words.
- **C:** Incorrect: it invents a comparison with Wundt that the review does not make.
- **D:** Incorrect: the review appeared in 1894 in the *Zeitschrift für Philosophie und philosophische Kritik*.

Examiner trap 27: Quotation marks around a paraphrase are a fabrication risk in every philosophy answer, and this particular sentence is the most frequently misattributed line in the Husserl literature.

MCQ 28. Remedial drill - what caused the reversal

How should the relation between Frege's review and Husserl's anti-psychologistic turn be stated?

- A. Frege's review caused the reversal, as Husserl acknowledged in the preface to the *Logical Investigations*.
- B. Frege's review coincided with, and probably sharpened, a reversal whose sources scholars still dispute.
- C. Frege's review had no bearing whatever on Husserl, who never read it and reversed himself for unrelated reasons.
- D. Frege's review persuaded Husserl to abandon logic for descriptive psychology, a decision reversed only in 1913.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the causal claim is contested and cannot be asserted flatly; Føllesdal (1958) argued for it, but it is not a settled matter of record.
- **B:** Correct: Mohanty's *Husserl and Frege* (1982) argues from the manuscripts that the anti-psychologism was already developing from Bolzano and Lotze and from Husserl's own difficulties with the 1891 book.
- **C:** Incorrect: it overstates in the opposite direction and denies a coincidence that is not in doubt.
- **D:** Incorrect: the direction of travel is reversed - the movement is away from psychologism, not towards it.

Examiner trap 28: Asserting a contested causal claim as fact is penalised twice over, once for the error and once for the lost opportunity to display awareness of the Føllesdal-Mohanty dispute in a single clause.

MCQ 29. Remedial drill - the time-lectures

How should *On the Phenomenology of the Consciousness of Internal Time* be cited?

- A. As a book Husserl wrote and published in 1928, at the height of his Freiburg period.
- B. As a posthumous compilation assembled from manuscripts by Walter Biemel for the *Husserliana* series.
- C. As the second volume of the *Logical Investigations*, in which the analysis of temporal objects first appears.
- D. As lectures and manuscripts of 1893-1917, edited by Edith Stein and published by Heidegger in 1928.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Husserl did not prepare the text for print, and describing it as his 1928 book misstates both authorship of the edition and the period of composition.
- **B:** Incorrect: Biemel edited the *Crisis* as *Husserliana* VI; the time-lectures have a different editorial history.
- **C:** Incorrect: Volume II of the *Logical Investigations* contains the six Investigations, not the time-analysis.
- **D:** Correct: the composition dates and the editorial chain are both examinable, and the safe citation names Stein as editor and Heidegger as publisher.

Examiner trap 29: Attributing the edition to Husserl obscures the fact that he was still alive when Heidegger published it, and it removes a detail that costs eight words and reliably signals that the text has been handled rather than heard about.

MCQ 30. Remedial drill - the transcendental ego

Which description of the transcendental ego is correct?

- A. A field of sense-constitution, intentional, temporal and habitual, and not a mental substance of any kind.
- B. A thinking substance whose existence is more certain than that of any body, disclosed once the world is bracketed.
- C. The empirical psyche in its purified form, freed of the errors that ordinary introspection introduces into it.
- D. The formal unity of apperception, exactly as Kant describes it, adopted without modification by Husserl.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: it is that *for which* meaning is constituted, and Husserl analyses its habitualities and sedimented temporal history.
- **B:** Incorrect: the substance-inference is precisely what the reduction refuses, which is the first divergence from Descartes.
- **C:** Incorrect: the empirical psyche is a mundane object bracketed along with the rest of the world.
- **D:** Incorrect: the identification holds only without qualification, which is what Husserl's analysis of habituality and temporal constitution rules out.

Examiner trap 30: Describing the transcendental ego as "what is left over" after the reduction invites the substance reading; the accurate formula is a constituting field, and it also explains why the ego can be intersubjectively completed rather than sealed.

MCQ 31. Remedial drill - what the Fifth Meditation does

Which one of the following states the task of the Fifth *Cartesian Meditation* correctly?

- A. To prove that other minds exist, by inferring from the similarity of another's body to my own that a similar consciousness animates it.
- B. To show how the sense "another subject, for whom the world is also there" is constituted, with the evidence proper to it.
- C. To establish that the transcendental ego is one among many, and that the world is therefore constituted collectively.
- D. To demonstrate that solipsism is logically incoherent, and hence that the sceptical hypothesis need not be considered.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: an argument from analogy is exactly what Husserl denies he is offering; pairing is a passive synthesis and appresentation an analogising transfer of sense.
- **B:** Correct: proof of existence is a natural-attitude demand that the epoche has suspended, so the question is one of sense-constitution and its verification by concordance.
- **C:** Incorrect: the order of constitution in the Meditation is asymmetrical - I am constituted first, others through me - which is precisely what Schutz challenges.
- **D:** Incorrect: no demonstration of incoherence is attempted, and Husserl treats the solipsism charge as the most serious objection to his own programme.

Examiner trap 31: Reading the Fifth Meditation as a failed proof of other minds misidentifies the task and forfeits the strongest available sentence on this sub-topic, namely that the other's non-original givenness belongs to the very sense "other".

MCQ 32. Remedial drill - the ownership fence

Which one of the following belongs to syllabus item 9 rather than to another clause?

- A. Being-in-the-world and ecstatic temporality, together with the claim that the essence of Dasein lies in its existence.
- B. The verification principle, the elimination of metaphysics as pseudo-statement, and the linguistic theory of necessity.
- C. The eidetic reduction, free imaginative variation, and the correlational a priori between noesis and noema.
- D. Methodic doubt, the proof of the external world through divine non-deception, and the real distinction of mind and body.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Heidegger's positive doctrine belongs to Topic 10, Existentialism, and appears here only as criticism of a method he inherited.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is Topic 07, Logical Positivism - a rival that shares the anti-metaphysical direction while rejecting eidetic intuition outright.
- **C:** Correct: all three are owned by the printed clause, and together they constitute the theory of essences and its link to the method.
- **D:** Incorrect: Descartes' own system belongs to Topic 02, Rationalism, and is needed here only as the contrast term in the 2025 part.

Examiner trap 32: Expounding Heidegger, Sartre or Merleau-Ponty at length in a Husserl answer transfers marks to another clause; each may be named in a single clause identifying the specific doctrine he rejects, and no more.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key; UPSC publishes no descriptive model answers for Philosophy Paper I. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers, including the typographic quotation marks the repository ledger records. The 2018 to 2025 Paper I texts are held locally, and the English wording of every part below - including the two supporting parts owned by other topics - follows the repository's verified Western Philosophy PYQ ledger. *Ideas I* is cited by **Section number**, which is stable across the Boyce Gibson (1931) and Kersten (1982) translations; every other work is cited by title with its dates of composition and publication wherever the two differ, because several of the texts this clause depends on are posthumous. Interpretive disputes - what the noema ultimately is, whether the Fifth Meditation escapes solipsism, and whether the transcendental turn reinstates what the *Prolegomena* expelled - are flagged as contested rather than settled.

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper I parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands used here are **10 marks - about 150 to 220 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 330 words**, and **20 marks - about 330 to 400 words**. Every solution below sits inside its declared band, and the demand decoding, the verdict heading and the "why this earns marks" notes are teaching apparatus that sit **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage. ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: this clause owns **7 of 112** Western Philosophy question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus, with **2018 the only year without an owned part**. All seven are solved in full below, followed by **two supporting routed parts** that bear directly on this clause while being owned elsewhere, and **six original solved Mains models**, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks. The internal distribution is worth knowing before the exam: **method** is tested in 2021, 2023 and 2025 - three of seven parts, in three different framings; **psychologism** in 2020 and 2022, two years apart and in almost the same words; **essences** in 2024; and **intentionality** in 2019. A candidate who prepares the theory of essences but cannot execute the method has prepared under a third of the clause.

Solved PYQ 1 · 2019 · Q1(b) · 10 marks

Question: Can hallucination be regarded as an intentional act by Husserl? Explain.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Can ... ? Explain." - a yes/no ruling followed by its reason , not a survey
Core issue	Whether intentionality requires an existing object
Scope boundary	Ten marks: definition, the criterion, the case analysed, what is missing, one limit
Ideal thesis	Yes - because the criterion is directedness, and what hallucination lacks is fulfilment, not structure
Non-negotiables	noesis and noema named; "directedness not reference"; the noema is not an inner picture

Independent model answer

Thesis. Yes. On Husserl's account hallucination is a fully intentional act, and the reason exposes what intentionality is.

The criterion. Intentionality, inherited from Brentano and transformed, is the thesis that every act of consciousness is consciousness *of* something. Its structure is the correlation of the **noesis**, the manner of intending, with the **noema**, the object precisely as intended. The criterion is **directedness**, not successful reference.

The case. A hallucination has a perceptual-seeming noesis: it is lived in the manner of *perceiving*, not of imagining. It has a determinate noema - this shape, this colour, at this place, with unseen sides co-intended. Both members of the correlation are present.

What is missing. Not structure but **intuitive fulfilment**. The empty intentions belonging to the object are not honoured, and the failure appears as **disappointment** when the further course of perception fails to concord. FACT: *Ideas I* Section 24 grounds cognition in originary givenness only *within the limits* in which it is given, so an unfulfilled intention is a legitimate object of description.

Qualification. ANALYSIS: Saying yes does not make hallucination veridical. The veridical/non-veridical distinction is retained and re-described as a difference in fulfilment rather than in intentional form. The noema must not be treated as an inner picture; that would restore the veil of ideas the analysis removes.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the directive is "Explain", so the ruling must arrive in the first line and every later sentence must earn it.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: thesis one line; criterion three; case three; what is missing three; qualification two.

- **Structure:** ruling -> criterion -> the case -> the missing element -> the limit.
- **Doctrine:** directedness, noesis-noema, fulfilment and disappointment.
- **Evidence:** Brentano's inheritance; *Ideas I* (1913) vocabulary; Section 24's limiting clause.
- **Distinction:** directedness against reference; unfulfilled against defective.
- **Criticism:** the picture-reading of the noema, refused in one clause.

Solved PYQ 2 · 2020 · Q1(c) · 10 marks

Question: What, according to Husserl, is wrong with psychologism? How does Husserl address the problems with psychologism in his phenomenological method?

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two questions - a diagnosis and then a method-link ; both must be answered
Core issue	Why logical validity cannot be an empirical generalisation, and what the method does about it
Scope boundary	Ten marks: definition, the root confusion, the four arguments compressed, the positive result
Ideal thesis	The four arguments are consequences of one confusion, and the method secures ideal contents without denying real acts
Non-negotiables	<i>Prolegomena</i> , Volume I, 1900-01; act against content; self-refutation; ideal objectivity

Independent model answer

Thesis. Psychologism mistakes the content thought for the act of thinking it, and Husserl's method keeps the two apart without banishing consciousness from logic.

The diagnosis. Psychologism holds that logical laws are empirical generalisations about how human beings in fact think - held by Mill, Lipps and Sigwart, and by Husserl in the *Philosophie der Arithmetik* (1891). The *Prolegomena to Pure Logic*, Volume I of the *Logical Investigations* (1900-01), gives four arguments. **(i)** Psychological laws are inductive and probable; logical laws are necessary, and the necessary cannot be derived from the probable. **(ii)** The ideal content " $2+2=4$ " is not a feature of the datable act of judging it - the **root confusion**. **(iii)** Species-relative truth is **self-refuting**, since "truth is relative" is asserted as absolutely true. **(iv)** The conditions of thinking are not the grounds of validity; conflating them is the genetic fallacy.

The method-link. ANALYSIS: Phenomenology does not exclude consciousness; it studies consciousness **as the site where ideal meanings are grasped**, refusing to reduce those meanings to the acts that grasp them. The acts are real, the contents ideal. Bracketing removes the positing that would let a psychic event pass for a ground of validity, and eidetic analysis treats structures.

Qualification. CAUTION: Whether the transcendental turn reinstates the difficulty is contested; the reply that constitution is disclosure is coherent, not decisive.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the second sentence of the question is a *method* question. An answer that stops after the four arguments answers half.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: thesis one line; diagnosis five; method-link three; qualification one.

- **Structure:** thesis -> definition and named holders -> four arguments -> what the method does -> the open worry.
- **Doctrine:** ideal content against real act; ideal objectivity.
- **Evidence:** 1891; *Prolegomena*, Vol. I, 1900-01; Mill, Lipps, Sigwart.
- **Distinction:** anti-psychologism is not anti-mentalism.
- **Criticism:** the transcendental-turn worry, named and left open.

Solved PYQ 3 · 2021 · Q4(a) · 20 marks

Question: Present a critical exposition of Husserl's criticism of 'natural attitude'. How does Husserl propose to address the problems involved in natural attitude through his phenomenological method?

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Critical exposition" then "How ... address" - exposition with assessment , then remedy
Core issue	That the defect is a blocked question, and that the remedy must therefore be a change of attitude
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the thesis, its scope, the exact criticism, the remedy in four operations, three objections, verdict
Ideal thesis	The natural attitude is criticised for what it cannot ask, so it is suspended and not refuted
Non-negotiables	general thesis; the sciences included; "uncritical, not false"; suspension against doubt; a defended ruling

Independent model answer

Thesis. Husserl's quarrel with the natural attitude is not that it asserts something false but that it never asks anything: it lives on a positing it cannot examine, and philosophy must therefore change its attitude rather than its beliefs.

The general thesis. In the natural attitude the world is pre-given: it exists, has always existed, and would exist without me. This standing positing - the **general thesis** (*Generalthesis*) - is lived, not asserted, and becomes visible only when a philosopher neutralises it.

Its scope. FACT: It covers not only common sense but the **natural sciences**, which dispute what the world contains while presupposing that it is there, and empirical psychology, which treats consciousness as one worldly item. The sciences are therefore not the cure for naivety about the world but its most disciplined form.

The criticism, exactly. ANALYSIS: The attitude is **uncritical, not false**. So long as we remain inside it, the foundational question - how does the world come to have meaning for us? - cannot be formulated, since any answer would presuppose the positing at issue. The sceptic is no better placed: he merely answers the existence-question negatively and keeps it primary.

The remedy. Because the defect is a blocked question, the remedy is a **change of attitude**. **Suspension** (*epoche*) brackets the existence-posit while retaining the full content of experience; the **phenomenological reduction** leads inquiry back from *what is this?* to *how is it given?*; the **eidetic reduction** extracts invariants by free imaginative variation; and the **transcendental reduction** asks for the constituting subjectivity for which sense arises. ANALYSIS: These are distinct operations, not one mechanical ladder.

Critical assessment. CAUTION: Three objections deserve statement. **Heidegger** holds that a being always already in the world cannot bracket being-in-the-world. **Merleau-Ponty** concedes from within that the most important lesson of the reduction is the impossibility of a complete reduction (Landes 2012). And the reduction arguably presupposes the reflective access it is meant to clarify.

Verdict. The criticism succeeds as a diagnosis and the remedy succeeds as a change of attitude; complete presuppositionlessness remains a regulative aspiration rather than an achievement.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "critical exposition" is one demand, not two: assess *while* expounding, and reserve the verdict for the close.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: thesis two lines; general thesis three; scope three; criticism four; remedy six; assessment four; verdict two.

- **Structure:** thesis -> general thesis -> scope -> the exact criticism -> four operations -> three objections -> ruling.
- **Doctrine:** positing, blocked question, change of attitude.
- **Evidence:** *Ideas* / Section Section 31-32; Heidegger 1927; Merleau-Ponty 1945.
- **Distinction:** uncritical against false; suspension against denial.

- **Criticism:** the incomplete reduction, conceded and turned into the verdict.

Solved PYQ 4 · 2022 · Q1(d) · 10 marks

Question: What is psychologism? Critically discuss the way Edmund Husserl avoids the problem of psychologism in the discourse of transcendental phenomenology.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Definition, then "critically discuss" - the criticism must reach transcendental phenomenology
Core issue	Whether locating constitution in the transcendental ego reinstates what the <i>Prolegomena</i> expelled
Scope boundary	Ten marks: definition, arguments compressed, the reflexive worry, the three-part reply, verdict
Ideal thesis	The avoidance is genuine at the level of the <i>Prolegomena</i> and contested at the transcendental level
Non-negotiables	the empirical/transcendental distinction; constitution ≠ fabrication; a ruling

Independent model answer

Definition. Psychologism is the doctrine that the laws of logic are empirical generalisations about how human beings in fact think - that logic is a branch of descriptive psychology.

The refutation. The *Prolegomena* (1900-01) argue that necessary laws cannot be derived from probable ones; that the ideal content of a judgement is not a feature of the act of judging it; that species-relative truth refutes itself; and that conditions of thinking are not grounds of validity.

The reflexive worry. ANALYSIS: After *Ideas* (1913) all meaning-constitution is located in the **transcendental ego**. If truth is "constituted in transcendental subjectivity", has subject-dependence returned?

The three-part reply. (1) The transcendental ego is **not** the empirical psyche: the psyche is a mundane object *within* the world, while the ego is the condition under which world and psyche have meaning at all, so reducing to it is not psychology. **(2) Constitution is not fabrication.** The sense of " $2+2=4$ " is *disclosed*, not invented; subjectivity is the medium of access, not the source of validity. **(3)** Objectivity rests on **transcendental intersubjectivity**.

Verdict. CAUTION: The reply is coherent but not decisive. The third limb transfers the burden to the Fifth *Cartesian Meditation*, whose ownness-first order remains exposed to Schutz's circularity charge (1957); neo-Kantian and analytic critics hold that the transcendental ego stays too close to the idealist subject.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the phrase "in the discourse of transcendental phenomenology" is the whole question. Answering with the four arguments alone stops one step short.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: definition one line; refutation three; worry two; reply four; verdict two.

- **Structure:** definition -> refutation compressed -> the reflexive worry -> three-part reply -> ruling.
- **Doctrine:** empirical psyche against transcendental ego; disclosure against fabrication.
- **Evidence:** *Prolegomena* 1900-01; *Ideas* 1913; Schutz 1957.
- **Distinction:** medium of access against source of validity.
- **Criticism:** the reply is coherent, not decisive - stated as the verdict, not as a hedge.

Solved PYQ 5 · 2023 · Q3(b) · 15 marks

Question: Elucidate the significance of bracketing and reduction in Husserl's phenomenological method.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Elucidate the significance" - why they are needed , not what they are
Core issue	What would be lost if the operations were not performed
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: what is bracketed, the four operations distinguished, the three purposes, one limitation
Ideal thesis	Bracketing and reduction convert a naive gaze into a philosophical one, at a cost Husserl himself acknowledges
Non-negotiables	the bracket falls on the existence-posit; four distinct operations; three purposes; the incomplete-reduction objection

Independent model answer

Thesis. Bracketing and reduction are significant because of three things they make possible, each of which would otherwise be lost.

What is bracketed. Suspension (*epoche*) puts the general thesis of the natural attitude **out of play**: the existence-positing is neither affirmed nor denied. ANALYSIS: The bracket falls on a validity-claim, never on a content - the tree is still described as green, seen from this side, with unseen sides co-intended. What remains, the **residue**, is the whole field of pure experience, and it is wider than what the natural attitude records.

Four operations, not one ladder. The **phenomenological reduction** leads inquiry back - *re-ducere* - from *what is this object?* to *how is it given?*; the **eidetic reduction** moves from the factual instance to its essence by free imaginative variation; the **transcendental reduction** asks for the constituting subjectivity for which sense and validity arise. ANALYSIS: Eidetic analysis already operates in the *Logical Investigations* (1900-01), before the transcendental turn of *Ideas I* (1913), so the operations must not be presented as fixed rungs.

The three purposes. (i) **Evidence under a changed attitude:** the stream is apodictically unavoidable as *experienced*, though apodicticity is not exhaustive transparency and particular self-descriptions stay corrigible - precisely what *Ideas I* Section 24 requires by limiting evidence to what is given within the limits of its givenness. (ii) **No substance-inference:** consciousness is analysed as intentional life rather than established as a separate mental thing, which reformulates rather than dissolves the mind-body problem. (iii) **Eidetic and transcendental questions become askable:** only a field cleared of factual commitment can be varied for invariants; without this, phenomenology would be a diary of episodes - that is, empirical psychology.

Limitation. CAUTION: Merleau-Ponty's Preface (1945) concedes from inside phenomenology that a complete reduction is impossible; the operations are best defended as a repeatable change of attitude rather than as a standpoint achieved once and for all.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "significance" is a why-question. Every paragraph should name what would be lost without the operation described.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: thesis one line; what is bracketed three; four operations four; three purposes six; limitation two.

- **Structure:** thesis -> the bracket -> the four operations -> the three purposes -> the conceded limit.
- **Doctrine:** *re-ducere*; apodicticity without transparency; intentional life against substance.
- **Evidence:** *Ideas I* Section 24, 31-32; *Logical Investigations* 1900-01; Merleau-Ponty 1945.
- **Distinction:** phenomenological against eidetic reduction.
- **Criticism:** the incomplete reduction, used as a limitation rather than a refutation.

Solved PYQ 6 · 2024 · Q4(b) · 15 marks

Question: Why does Husserl think that essences exhibit a kind of continuity between consciousness and being? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Why ... ? Discuss." - a reason , then its examination
Core issue	The correlational a priori, and the exact sense of "continuity"
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: what essences are, the correlation, one worked case, what the claim is not, the idealism question
Ideal thesis	Continuity means that neither pole is separately describable, not that the two poles merge
Non-negotiables	essence as invariant; the worked two-sided case; no third entity; realism/idealism reframed, not settled

Independent model answer

Thesis. Husserl's claim is not that mind and world are one substance but that neither can be described without the other, and essences are where that mutual dependence becomes visible.

Essences. An essence (*Wesen*, *eidos*) is the invariant without which a phenomenon would cease to be that kind of thing. It is ideal, not causally efficacious and **not generated by mental acts**; and it is given **in and through** instances, not in a separate realm.

The correlational a priori. FACT: The essential structure of the object *as experienced* is correlated with the essential structure of the act that intends it. Object-as-experienced and experiencing-act are not two independently existing entities that happen to meet; they are **essentially correlated**.

The worked case. Take the essence of "perception of a spatial thing". On the object side: three-dimensionality, and an internal horizon of further profiles never exhausted by one appearance. On the act side: perspectival givenness through profiles (*Abschattungen*), unseen sides co-intended, and a temporal synthesis of identification holding the series together as one thing. ANALYSIS: Each specification entails the other. State three-dimensionality and you have specified perspectival givenness; state perspectival givenness and you have specified a horizoned object. That mutual entailment **is** the continuity.

What the claim is not. ANALYSIS: Not a merger of subject and object; not the positing of a third entity between them - the noema is the object *as intended*, not a middle term; and not the claim that consciousness manufactures being, since constitution is disclosure and not fabrication.

Discussion. CAUTION: The doctrine reframes the realism/idealism dispute: the primary question becomes how world-sense is constituted rather than whether the world exists independently. Whether the reframing *avoids* idealism is contested - Husserl's mature position is an avowed transcendental idealism, though it is not Berkeley's, since the noema is an objective correlate accessible to other subjects and objectivity is completed only by transcendental intersubjectivity.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the marked word is "continuity". Build the answer around the two-column case, and the demand is met before the criticism begins.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: thesis one line; essences two; correlation two; worked case five; what it is not three; discussion three.

- **Structure:** thesis -> essence -> correlation -> worked case -> three denials -> the idealism question.
- **Doctrine:** correlational a priori; constitution as disclosure.
- **Evidence:** profiles, horizon, synthesis of identification; the *Ideas* / noesis-noema vocabulary.
- **Distinction:** correlation against identity; correlate against intermediary.
- **Criticism:** reframing is not settling - stated as the closing ruling.

Solved PYQ 7 · 2025 · Q4(a) · 20 marks

Question: How is Husserl's account of "I think" different from that of Descartes? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"How ... different ... Critically discuss" - a comparison on named axes , then a ruling
Core issue	What each takes himself to have found in the thinking self
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the shared ambition, three divergences, the solipsism cost, the Fifth Meditation, verdict
Ideal thesis	Descartes infers a substance and needs God; Husserl refuses the inference and never loses the world - at the price of the other
Non-negotiables	the agreement stated first; substance, world-access, scope of the ego; appresentation not inference; a defended ruling

Independent model answer

Thesis. Both begin at the same place and part company over what they take themselves to have found there: Descartes finds a thing, Husserl finds a point of view - and only one of them needs God to get the world back.

The agreement. Both start from the indubitable **self-giveness of the thinking act**, and both want a presuppositionless beginning. Denying this removes the axis on which the comparison turns.

Divergence 1 - substance. Descartes concludes to a **thinking substance** (*res cogitans*). Husserl **suspends that mundane ontological inference**: what the transcendental reduction discloses is a **field of sense-constitution**, expressly not a *res cogitans*, not the empirical psyche, and not Kant's formal "I think" without qualification, since Husserl analyses habitualities, sedimentation and temporal constitution.

Divergence 2 - world-access. Descartes must rebuild world-knowledge and invokes **divine non-deception** to do it. Husserl never denies the world; he brackets its natural-attitude **positing** and analyses its modes of givenness.
ANALYSIS: **No God-bridge is needed because no chasm was opened.**

Divergence 3 - scope of the ego. Husserl's ego is intentional, **temporal** and ultimately **intersubjective**, not a sealed inner thing.

The cost. CAUTION: If all sense is constituted for my ego, other egos become problematic - the charge of **transcendental solipsism**, which Husserl regards as the most serious objection to his own programme. The Fifth *Cartesian Meditation* (Paris lectures 1929; French 1931; German 1950) replies by reducing to the **sphere of ownness**, isolating the **lived body** (*Leib*) as the absolute "here", pairing it with another governed, expressive body in a **passive synthesis**, and **appresenting** the other's subjectivity as the unseen back of a table is appresented in seeing its front. ANALYSIS: This is an analogising transfer of sense, **not** an argument from analogy, and non-originality is constitutive: were the other's stream given originally, he would be me.

Verdict. Husserl advances decisively beyond Descartes by refusing the substance-inference and the divine guarantee. The advance is not free: Schutz's circularity objection (1957), Sartre's Look (1943) and Levinas's charge that an alter ego is not an Other (1961) leave the intersubjective question genuinely open, and the transcendental idealism Husserl reaches keeps a constitutive role for subjectivity that is structurally close to - though not identical with - the idealism he is often accused of.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: state the agreement first. A comparison without a shared axis reads as two portraits and is marked as one.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: thesis two lines; agreement two; three divergences seven; the cost six; verdict three.

- **Structure:** thesis -> agreement -> three named divergences -> the solipsism cost and its reply -> ruling.
- **Doctrine:** constituting field; bracketing against denial; appresentation.
- **Evidence:** Paris 1929, French 1931, German 1950; Schutz 1957; Sartre 1943; Levinas 1961.

- **Distinction:** substance against field; suspension against denial; transfer of sense against inference.
- **Criticism:** the intersubjective residue, conceded and used to qualify the verdict.

SUPPORTING ROUTED PARTS THAT BEAR ON THIS CLAUSE BUT ARE OWNED ELSEWHERE

ANALYSIS: Both parts below name material taught in this package, and both are **owned by another clause**. They are included so that the boundary is explicit: each carries a bounded contribution-and-boundary note rather than a full-band model answer, because writing them as Husserl answers would transfer marks to the wrong topic.

Supporting part A · 2018 · Q4(a) · 20 marks · owned by Topic 10, Existentialism

Question: What is 'Epoche'? How does Heidegger reject this method of phenomenological reduction? Explain Heidegger's concept of 'being in the world' as opposed to the concept of a transcendental ego.

What this clause contributes. Only the first sentence. Define suspension exactly - the general thesis is put out of play, the existence-posit is neither affirmed nor denied, the content of experience is retained, and the residue is the full field of pure experience - and state in one clause that the epoche is a repeatable change of attitude rather than a doubt or a denial. Add, if there is room, that the transcendental ego disclosed by the transcendental reduction is a **constituting field** and not a *res cogitans*, since that is the target Heidegger attacks.

Boundary. ANALYSIS: Everything after the first sentence belongs to **Topic 10**: Heidegger's rejection of the reduction and of the theoretical attitude, being-in-the-world, thrownness, and the claim that Dasein cannot be modelled on a Cartesian subject. This clause supplies the definition Heidegger is rejecting and the characterisation of the ego he replaces; it does not supply the positive Heideggerian doctrine, and an answer that expounds Husserl at length here has misallocated a twenty-mark part. ANALYSIS: **This is also the only year in which this clause owns nothing**, which is exactly why the epoche must be defined accurately in one compact paragraph.

Supporting part B · 2022 · Q4(b) · 15 marks · owned by Topic 02, Rationalism

Question: How does Rene Descartes explain the notion of certainty with reference to knowledge of the self? Critically discuss the way it differs from the knowledge of the world.

What this clause contributes. A single comparative paragraph, if the directive invites it. Descartes' asymmetry - the self known with certainty, the world recovered only through divine non-deception - is exactly the structure Husserl's method is designed to avoid, because bracketing the world's positing opens no chasm to be crossed. One sentence naming that contrast strengthens a Descartes answer without displacing it.

Boundary. ANALYSIS: The exposition - methodic doubt, the *cogito*, clear and distinct ideas, the God-proofs and the real distinction - belongs to **Topic 02**. Husserl appears here as a **later contrast**, at most in a closing evaluative clause, and never as the subject of the answer.

Six original questions, two at each mark value, testing the same doctrine at three different lengths and in framings the 2018-2025 corpus has not used. Each model answer sits inside its declared band.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish between retention and recollection in Husserl's analysis of inner time-consciousness. Why does the distinction matter?

Independent model answer

Thesis. Retention is a moment of the present perception; recollection is a re-presentation of what is no longer present - and if the distinction collapses, the perception of a temporal object becomes unintelligible.

The distinction. The living present has three moments: the **primal impression** (*Urimpression*), the now-phase or source-point; **retention**, the just-elapsed phase still held within the present, sinking in clarity as the running-off phenomena (*Ablaufphänomene*); and **protention**, the empty anticipation of the phase about to come. **Retention is primary memory. Recollection** (*Wiedererinnerung*) is secondary memory, a **re-presentation** (*Vergegenwärtigung*) of something that has passed away.

Why it matters. ANALYSIS: Consider a melody. If the just-played note were *remembered* rather than still heard as just-past, the melody would have to be complete before it could be perceived, and a series of isolated tones could never be given as a sequence at all. The same holds for a spoken sentence, whose earlier words must be retained for it to carry sense.

Consequences. The analysis locates the self in the **constituting flow** rather than among Hume's discrete impressions, and makes habituality and sedimentation intelligible, since a merely recorded past could not be *my* past.

Qualification. CAUTION: The account faces a regress - if the flow constitutes time, what constitutes the flow? Husserl answers that the flow constitutes its own unity, which commentators read either as self-grounding or as stipulation.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** thesis -> three moments -> the contrast -> the melody test -> consequences -> the regress.
- **Evidence:** lectures 1893-1917, edited by Edith Stein, published by Heidegger 1928.
- **Distinction:** primary against secondary memory; held against re-presented.
- **Criticism:** the self-constituting flow, conceded as reflexively difficult.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: "The epoche brackets the world." Examine the accuracy of this formulation.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The formulation is close enough to be repeated and wrong enough to lose the topic: what is bracketed is not the world but the **positing** of its existence.

What is bracketed. The **general thesis** of the natural attitude - the standing positing that the world exists independently of my awareness of it. *Ideas I* Section Section 31-32 describe it as put out of play and placed in brackets.

What survives. FACT: The stream of consciousness with all its intentional contents; the full descriptive content of what appears - colour, shape, distance, profile, horizon; and the object's presenting itself as the kind of object it presents itself to be. The **residue** is therefore **wider**, not narrower, than the field the natural attitude records.

Why the loose formula misleads. ANALYSIS: It suggests removal, and removal invites two further errors: that Husserl doubts the world, which confuses suspension with Cartesian denial; and that the epoche by itself establishes idealism, which runs an operation of method together with a later argued result about constitution.

Accurate reformulation. The epoche brackets a **validity-claim**, never a content; it is a repeatable, reversible **change of attitude**, and its yield is descriptive richness rather than loss.

Qualification. CAUTION: That the change of attitude can be carried through completely is disputed: Merleau-Ponty's 1945 Preface treats a complete reduction as impossible, which limits the operation without discrediting it.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** ruling -> what is bracketed -> what survives -> why the formula misleads -> reformulation -> limit.
- **Evidence:** *Ideas I* Section Section 31-32; Merleau-Ponty 1945.
- **Distinction:** validity-claim against content; suspension against denial.
- **Criticism:** the incomplete reduction, used as a boundary rather than a refutation.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: Assess Husserl's claim that free imaginative variation yields knowledge of essences rather than empirical generalisations.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The claim stands or falls on a single point - that variation seeks a **limit** rather than a **frequency** - and that point is defensible, though it does not make eidetic claims incorrigible.

The technique. Begin from a factual instance; vary it freely in imagination in colour, size, material, duration and context; ask at each step whether the phenomenon survives or collapses into something else; what cannot be varied away without destroying it **is** its essence.

Why it is not induction. FACT: Induction generalises from many *observed* cases and yields probability, so further cases strengthen it. Variation is an **a priori** procedure conducted in imagination, and a **single instance suffices** to launch it, because what is sought is the point at which the phenomenon ceases to be itself - and no number of further instances makes a limit more secure.

The worked case. Vary a triangle's size, orientation, colour and material presentation: the closed three-sided plane-figure structure survives; remove a side and the phenomenon collapses. ANALYSIS: Note the method's own limit in the same breath: the **angle-sum** claim holds within a geometrical framework and must not be offered as the invariant of every possible geometry.

How the essence is grasped. Essences are **seen** rather than inferred, in an intuition of essences (*Wesensschau*), whose ancestor is the **categorical intuition** of the Sixth *Logical Investigation* - closely related, but not to be collapsed into one unchanged doctrine.

Assessment. CAUTION: The strong presupposition is that intellectual seeing is as legitimate as sense-perception, and Ryle and Ayer refuse it, asking how we could know that two subjects intuit the same essence. Husserl's answer is that evidence (*Evidenz*) is the **fulfilment** of an empty intention, graded and partial, not a feeling of certainty; the operative constraints are **counter-variation** and **intersubjective repeatability**.

Verdict. The distinction from induction is secure; the residual difficulty is **framework-dependence**, which the triangle example itself exhibits, so eidetic results are best treated as revisable within a specified region rather than as final.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** ruling -> technique -> why not induction -> worked case with its limit -> how grasped -> objection and reply -> verdict.
- **Evidence:** *Logical Investigations* VI; the triangle case with the angle-sum caution.
- **Distinction:** limit against frequency; eidetic against categorical intuition.
- **Criticism:** framework-dependence, drawn from the example rather than imported.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: Explain the distinction between sensuous *hyle* and intentional *morphe*, and evaluate its role in Husserl's rejection of sense-datum theory.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The hyle/morphe analysis is what entitles Husserl to say that we perceive things rather than appearances, and its weakness is the very feature that does the work.

The distinction. *Ideas I* Section 85 divides the noetic side of an act into **sensuous hyle** - hyletic or sensation-data (*Empfindungsdaten*), the non-intentional sensory content actually lived through - and **intentional morphe**, the animating apprehension (*Auffassung, Beseelung*) that interprets the material as a presentation of an object. Husserl's own formula is "sensuous *hylē*, intentional *morphē*".

Two properties that carry the argument. FACT: Hyle is **non-intentional**: it is not *of* anything and does not point beyond itself. And it is **lived through** (*erlebt*), not observed: I do not perceive my sensation-data, I perceive the house. Only the animated whole intends an object, which is why the same brownish colour-data can found *this house seen from the front, a brown patch in a painting, or a stain*.

The rejection of sense-datum theory. ANALYSIS: Because hyletic data are never the **objects** of perception, no inner item is interposed between subject and world: there is **no veil of ideas** and **no inference** from data to world. This is the precise point of separation from **Locke** and **Russell**, and it is the strongest defence available against the charge that phenomenology is subjectivism.

Evaluation. CAUTION: The difficulty is exact. If hyletic data are non-intentional, they cannot be given as anything; yet the principle of principles grounds cognition in what is originarily given. In what sense, then, are they given? Husserl's later genetic phenomenology largely absorbs the hyle into **passive synthesis**, which most commentators read as a tacit concession. At this same seam **Merleau-Ponty** rejects the scheme, holding that the body already organises the field before any apprehension, and **Sartre** abolishes hyletic contents altogether.

Verdict. The distinction succeeds in its negative task and is unstable in its positive one - which is why the anti-sense-datum result survives the difficulties that the hyle itself does not.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** ruling -> the distinction -> two properties -> the rejection -> the difficulty -> verdict.
- **Evidence:** *Ideas* / Section 85; Merleau-Ponty 1945; Sartre 1943.
- **Distinction:** lived through against observed; dependent moment against object.
- **Criticism:** the given-yet-non-intentional problem, with passive synthesis as the conceding repair.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "Husserl's transcendental phenomenology escapes psychologism only by relocating it." Critically examine.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The charge has real force but is not sustained: relocation would require that validity be *made* in transcendental subjectivity, and constitution is disclosure, not fabrication - though the reply is coherent rather than decisive.

What was expelled. The *Prolegomena to Pure Logic*, Volume I of the *Logical Investigations* (1900-01), argues that necessary logical laws cannot be derived from merely probable psychological ones; that the ideal content of a judgement is not a feature of the datable act of judging it; that species-relative truth is self-refuting; and that the causal conditions of thinking are not the grounds of validity. The positive result is **ideal objectivity**: real acts, ideal contents.

The charge. CAUTION: After *Ideas* (1913), all meaning-constitution is located in the **transcendental ego**. If truth is constituted in transcendental subjectivity, then validity again depends on a subject, and psychologism has returned wearing a transcendental coat.

The reply, in three parts. (1) The transcendental ego is **not** the empirical psyche. The psyche is a mundane object *within* the world and is bracketed with it; the transcendental ego is the condition under which world and psyche have sense at all. A reduction to it is therefore not a reduction to psychology, and the objection trades on treating "subject" univocally. (2) **Constitution is not creation.** To say the sense of " $2+2=4$ " is constituted is to say it is disclosed there; the content remains atemporal and objective, and subjectivity is the **medium of access**, not the **source of validity**. (3) Objectivity is finally grounded in **transcendental intersubjectivity**, not in one subject's dispositions.

What survives of the charge. ANALYSIS: Limb (3) transfers the burden to the Fifth *Cartesian Meditation*, whose ownness-first order - I am constituted first, others through me - is exposed to **Schutz's** circularity objection (1957): my body is recognised as a body *like others'* only if I already possess the sense "other". If intersubjectivity is not independently secured, limb (3) cannot carry the weight limb (2) leaves it.

Verdict. Psychologism proper is escaped, because nothing in the transcendental account makes logical validity depend on how any mind happens to work. What is not escaped is **transcendental idealism**, which is a different and weaker charge - and the reason neo-Kantian and analytic critics, with later Heidegger and Merleau-Ponty, remain unconvinced is that they doubt the distinction between disclosure and constitution can bear the weight Husserl places on it.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** ruling -> what was expelled -> the charge -> three-part reply -> what survives -> verdict.
- **Evidence:** *Prolegomena* 1900-01; *Ideas* 1913; Schutz 1957.
- **Distinction:** psychologism against transcendental idealism - two charges, not one.
- **Criticism:** the dependence of limb (3) on the Fifth Meditation, stated as the residue.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Evaluate Husserl's account of intersubjectivity in the Fifth *Cartesian Meditation* as a reply to the charge of transcendental solipsism.

Independent model answer

Thesis. The Fifth Meditation answers the question Husserl actually faces - how the sense "other subject" is constituted - and answers it well; it does not attempt to prove that other minds exist.

Correcting the question. ANALYSIS: Proof of other minds is a **natural-attitude** demand, and the epoche has suspended existence-positing. The task is to show how the sense "another subject, for whom the world is also there" arises in my experience. Answers treating it as a failed proof misidentify the task.

The argument. Reduce to the **sphere of ownness** (*Eigenheitssphäre*), abstracting from every sense owing to other subjectivity - cultural predicates such as "hammer" and "road", and all objectivity-for-anyone. Within it my **lived body** (*Leib*) is unique: the only physical thing that is also an organ of will, a field of sensings, and the absolute **"here"** from which all else is "there"; every other body is a mere *Körper*. Another body then appears resembling mine in governed expressive **behaviour**. A **pairing** (*Paarung*) occurs - a passive synthesis prior to judgement - and on its basis the other's subjectivity is **appresented**, co-intended without being presented, as the unseen back of a table is in seeing its front. ANALYSIS: This is an **analogising transfer of sense**, not an argument from analogy. The other is thus an **alter ego**.

The strongest move. FACT: **Non-originality is a necessity, not a defect.** Were the other's experiences given to me originally, he would not be an other - he would be me. Inaccessibility belongs to the **sense** "other", verified by the concordance of his conduct.

The objections. CAUTION: **Schutz** (1957) presses circularity: ownness is meant to be free of all reference to others, yet my body is recognised as a body *like others'* only because I already have that sense; Husserl replies that ownness is an **abstractive layer**, not a temporal stage. **Sartre** (1943) holds that the Other is met in **the Look**, which Husserl may answer presupposes the constituted sense "other subject". **Levinas** (1961) objects that an alter ego is not an Other, and the available reply **concedes**. **Heidegger** (1927, Section 26) denies there is a problem at all.

Verdict. As an analysis of how otherness and objectivity are constituted, the Meditation is Husserl's most impressive achievement, and the non-originality argument is decisive against the demand for original givenness. As a defence of the **ownness-first order** it remains exposed, and no verdict settles whether methodological solipsism is escaped.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** ruling -> correct the question -> nine-step argument compressed -> the strongest move -> four objections -> verdict.
- **Evidence:** Paris 1929; French 1931 (Levinas and Peiffer); German 1950; Schutz 1957; Sartre 1943; Levinas 1961; Heidegger 1927.
- **Distinction:** transfer of sense against inference; abstractive layer against temporal stage.
- **Criticism:** the Levinas reply conceded explicitly - a rare and highly creditable move.